



SSZG622 Software Project Management



BITS Pilani

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Individual Assignment 1

Topic : Schedule Management and Planning
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Executive Summary



- This report reviews the role of **schedule management and planning** in a mid-sized IT services organization that delivered an enhancement project for a retail e-commerce client.
- The project focused on upgrading the client's order processing platform with improved scalability and seamless payment integration.
- The project team used tools like Microsoft Project and sprint-based tracking to manage timelines. However, execution was affected by delays in client feedback, resource constraints, and overlooked interdependencies. These factors resulted in milestone shifts and additional coordination efforts.
- Despite these difficulties, structured monitoring through dashboards and frequent review sessions enabled the team to regain partial control and finish the project with only minor overruns. The case highlights how estimation precision, stakeholder involvement, and proactive risk planning can significantly strengthen schedule adherence.
- The findings emphasize the value of flexible scheduling approaches that combine structured planning with adaptive methods. Future initiatives can benefit from applying these practices to balance deadlines, resources, and client expectations more effectively.

Real-life Scenario



Company Overview:

- The case study is drawn from a mid-sized IT services provider (referred to as TechNova Solutions) with expertise in enterprise software delivery.
- The company employs around 1,200 professionals and executes projects across sectors including retail, banking, and healthcare.

Project Description:

- The selected project was **an e-commerce system enhancement** aimed at modernizing the client's online ordering solution.
- Major objectives included integrating secure payment gateways and enabling analytical dashboards for decision-making.
 1. Team Size: 35 (mix of developers, testers, analysts, and one project manager)
 2. Planned Duration: 8 months
 3. Delivery Approach: Hybrid Agile, combining upfront scheduling with sprint-based delivery
 4. Planned Milestones: Requirement freeze, sprint reviews, integration testing, UAT, and deployment



How Scheduling Was Applied

The project manager developed a **task hierarchy** through a Work Breakdown Structure (WBS) and mapped it into Microsoft Project for tracking. Dependencies were outlined, and a Gantt chart was used to visualize timelines. Agile ceremonies were included alongside formal planning:

- Three-week sprints with backlog refinement
- Daily stand-ups for task tracking
- Bi-weekly progress reviews with stakeholders Although the schedule was detailed and comprehensive, execution presented unforeseen challenges.

Observed Outcomes

The scheduling framework provided early visibility and clarity, but actual performance deviated from the baseline:

- Requirement Finalization Delays: Client-side approvals took 3 extra weeks.
- Integration Issues: Payment gateway testing was prolonged, postponing downstream activities.
- Resource Bottlenecks: Specialists were allocated across multiple projects, affecting availability.

Ultimately, the project concluded in 9 months, only one month later than planned and within budget, though not without stress on the team.



Key Challenges

1. **Overlooked Dependencies** – Coordination across modules was underestimated.
2. **Insufficient Contingency** – No effective buffer was built for testing and integration phases.
3. **Resource Sharing Conflicts** – Team members with critical expertise were double-booked.
4. **Slow Client Feedback** – Response cycles caused recurring slippages in milestones.

Personal Reflection

- This experience underlined that scheduling success is not only about detailed planning but also about anticipating uncertainties.
- Building flexibility into plans, improving estimation discipline, and involving stakeholders more actively would have prevented much of the delay

Thank You